

Blue Ranger

The MGU's underdog film. It plays the role *Captain America: The First Avenger* played for Marvel: the weakest of them becomes the one who never gives up.

Field	Detail
Release date	Friday, August 26, 2016, two days before the franchise's anniversary
Distributor	20th Century Fox
Rating / runtime	PG-13 / 160 minutes
Real title	Blue Ranger
Decoy title	Thunder Road
Whose film it is	Billy Cranston, the Blue Ranger. The film launches his line.

WHY THIS CHARACTER AND THIS DATE

Billy Cranston fills the Captain America role.

- **Billy is Steve Rogers.** In canon he starts as the weakest fighter on the team, a skinny genius who can't hold his own, and grows into a real fighter by training and refusing to quit.
- **He's also the original who lasts.** Billy is the only member of the original five who stays through all of MMPR and into Zeo, a link across eras the way Cap was across time.
- **The date:** it takes the anniversary weekend like Jason's films, with weak competition and two months after *White Ranger*, about the gap Marvel left between *Thor* and *The First Avenger*.

01 • TITLE: REAL AND DECOY

Blue Ranger, shot as Thunder Road

- **Real title:** *Blue Ranger*.
- **Decoy title:** *Thunder Road*. It sounds like a road movie, and it quietly hides the Thunderzords.

02 • WHOSE FILM IT IS

Billy Cranston, the Blue Ranger

- Billy's growth from the team's brain into one of its fighters.
- **Faithfulness lock:** there's no invented super-serum. Billy's strength comes from training and the Power, as in canon. All six Rangers are in the film at full strength.

03 • WHEN AND WHERE IT'S SET

MGU Year Two: spring 2014, set before *White Ranger*

- **When:** spring 2014, right after Lord Zedd arrives (the *Red Ranger 2* mid-credits scene) and before *White Ranger*. Like *The First Avenger*, it's released after a film it takes place before. A closing coda moves forward to just before the team film.
- **Where:** Angel Grove, Billy's garage lab, the Command Center, and Zedd's Moon palace.

04 • WHAT IT'S ABOUT

Never quit

- Lord Zedd has taken Rita's place, and his monsters are far more dangerous than hers. His first, **Pirantishead**, overpowers the Rangers, and the Dinozords aren't enough anymore.
- Billy has always been the weak link in a fight. He's been quietly training with Jason, getting knocked down and getting back up. Now that the team is outmatched, he's the one who works out how to fight Zedd's forces and won't let them give up.
- Zordon and Alpha 5 power the Dinozords up into the **Thunderzords**, as in canon, and Billy works alongside them to get the team ready for the new power.
- **Climax:** the **Thunder Megazord** debuts in Angel Grove. Billy, no longer the weakest Ranger, holds the line when the others go down.
- **Coda:** the film jumps forward. The *White Ranger* has arrived, Zedd is gathering his whole army, and Zordon tells Billy the team's biggest test is coming.

05 • VILLAIN / ANTAGONIST

Lord Zedd's first campaign

- **Lord Zedd** at full power, testing the Rangers.
- **Pirantishead**, Zedd's first monster in canon, is the film's main field threat. Goldar, Finster, Squatt and Baboo, and the debut of the **Z Putties** round it out.

06 • POST-CREDITS SCENES

One scene

- **End-credits: the teaser.** Just as *The First Avenger* ended on the first *Avengers* teaser, *Blue Ranger* ends with the first footage of the team film: all six Rangers morphing together, and then the title card **POWER RANGERS**. It's the first time the public gets confirmation of a team film, and it happens on screen, as the Secrecy Protocol requires.

07 • SETTING UP THE BIG BAD

Billy finds the signal

- While tracking the source of Zedd's power, Billy picks up a faint energy signature from deep space that's far stronger than Zedd's and seems to be watching Earth. Zordon goes quiet and tells him to log it and say nothing. It's the watcher from *Red Ranger's* end-credits scene: Dark Specter.
- This also starts Billy's role as the team's scientist of the Morphin Grid, which pays off in the Zeo and Turbo eras.

08 • ITS OWN WORLD-BUILDING

Billy's world

- Billy's garage lab and his inventions, his training with Jason, Zedd's first monster, the five Thunderzords (Red Dragon, Lion, Unicorn, Griffin, Firebird), and the Thunder Megazord.

09 • MGU WORLD-BUILDING

The rules every later film builds on

- **Zord power-ups:** Zords can be upgraded as threats grow, a rule that runs through every era.
- **Zedd's era is fully set up**, with Z Putties and his monster-making, for the team film.
- **The team film is publicly confirmed** for the first time, by the teaser.

10 • ITS ROLE IN PHASE 1

How it builds toward the team film

- Billy is the last solo hero set up before the team film, and the teaser tells the public what fans have suspected since 2013: the Power Rangers are coming together.

This is a fictional, alternate-history development document created for creative purposes. Characters and events follow the original Mighty Morphin Power Rangers series.